

at the same rate as professional paid-for software. This however doesn't handicap them entirely but does require us to expect less of them in terms of function and features. We filter out the many open source software for video editing to a short list which work across multiple platforms and can work at nearly the same level of performance as proprietary video editing suites.

Lightworks

Lightworks is an open source video editing platform that will surprise even the most seasoned video editors. Although many people in the world of Apple and Microsoft haven't heard of Lightworks, it is a fairly common utility for Linux users. The software is also available on Windows and Mac OS for absolutely free. Mostly. This 200 megabyte download only requires 2 GB of RAM to get up and running and surprises users at every turn in terms of its performance and functionality. The distinguishing feature of Lightworks is its extremely user customisable interface which is nothing more than a series of floating windows that can be activated or deactivated as per the user's preference. This free flowing layout allows users to create their own preferred working environment and doesn't bog their system down with unnecessary clutter. And despite its unconventional workflow and low system requirements it remains formidable in its usage and has all the same features that professional systems offer.



While a competent and effective program, Magix remains one step behind Adobe, Avid and Apple at every turn.

DaVinci Resolve Lite

DaVinci Resolve by Blackmagic is an essential industry grade video editing system that has become the gold standard for many editors. But we should not confuse DaVinci Resolve with DaVinci Resolve Lite which is an entirely new offering. Blackmagic's DaVinci Resolve is in actuality a professional level colour grading system that retails for USD 30,000 (Rs.20, 00,000/-) as a package which includes interface hardware. The low end version for desktop use is about USD 1,000 (Rs. 64,000/-) but the Lite version is completely free. Of course as we said in the intro to this FT, at places we'll be using free and OSS